eosc
Long Term Data Retention Task Force

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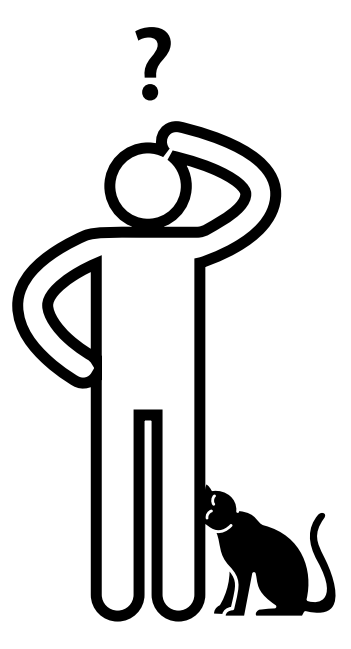
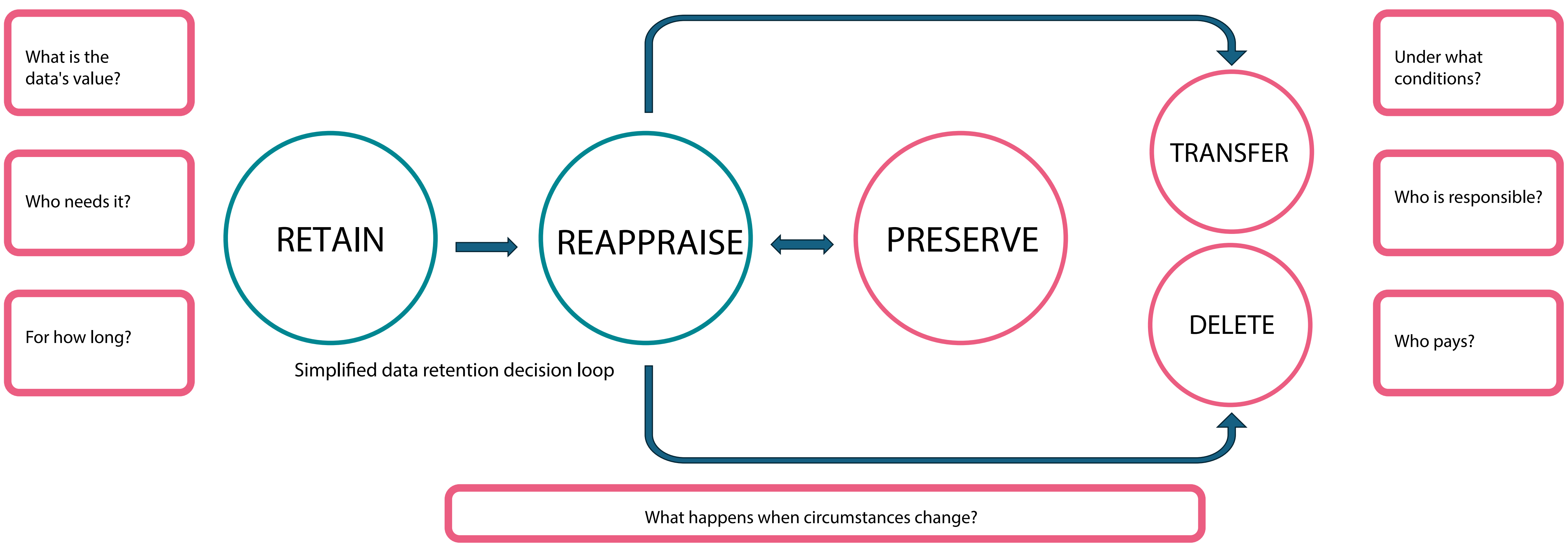
ARE WE ON THE RIGHT TRACK?

Seeking Community-Endorsed Guidance for Long-Term Data Retention



WHY DOES LONG-TERM RETENTION MATTER?

Research integrity | Reproducibility | Reuse | Accountability | Heritage


What is the data's value?

Who needs it?

For how long?

RETAIN → REAPPRAISE ↔ PRESERVE

TRANSFER

DELETE

Simplified data retention decision loop

Under what conditions?

Who is responsible?

Who pays?

What happens when circumstances change?

The nine challenges...

01 | FUNDING

Problem
Project funding often ends before preservation costs do.

Possible response
Dedicated post-project preservation funding and clearer responsibility from the outset.

02 | EXPERTISE

Problem
Retention requires expertise in metadata, appraisal, security, legal interpretation and repository management.

Possible response
Build skills, training and continuity of expertise into institutional practice.

03 | DISCIPLINES

Problem
Different disciplines have different formats, metadata, retention periods and preservation requirements.

Possible response
Develop adaptable discipline-specific preservation profiles and reappraisal triggers.

04 | STANDARDS & POLICY

Problem
Guidance for the end of the retention period remains much less developed than guidance for retention itself.

Possible response
Develop clearer approaches to reappraisal, deaccessioning and post-retention management.

05 | DATA VALUE

Problem
Data value is difficult to assess consistently, particularly when scientific, social, commercial and future reuse values differ.

Possible response
Combine data catalogues, data-management planning and explicit data-value/governance approaches.

06 | TECHNOLOGY

Problem
Technology changes — but organisational resources and preservation awareness can be just as significant a barrier.

Possible response
Combine flexible infrastructure with organisational capability, interoperability and preservation processes.

07 | LEGAL

Problem
Different jurisdictions, evolving legislation and cross-border research create uncertainty.

Possible response
Develop clearer, more transparent approaches to changing and overlapping legal requirements.

08 | ETHICS

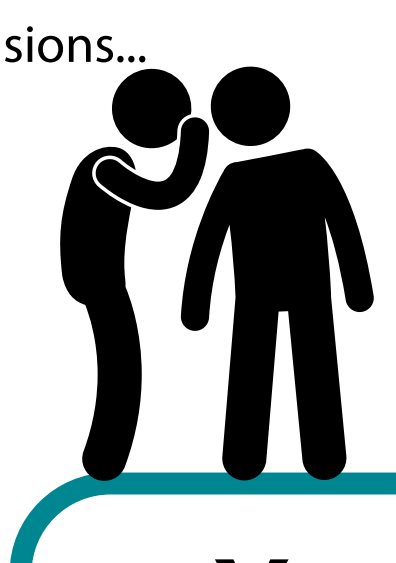
Problem
Privacy, cultural sensitivity, environmental impact and stewardship responsibilities do not disappear when research ends.

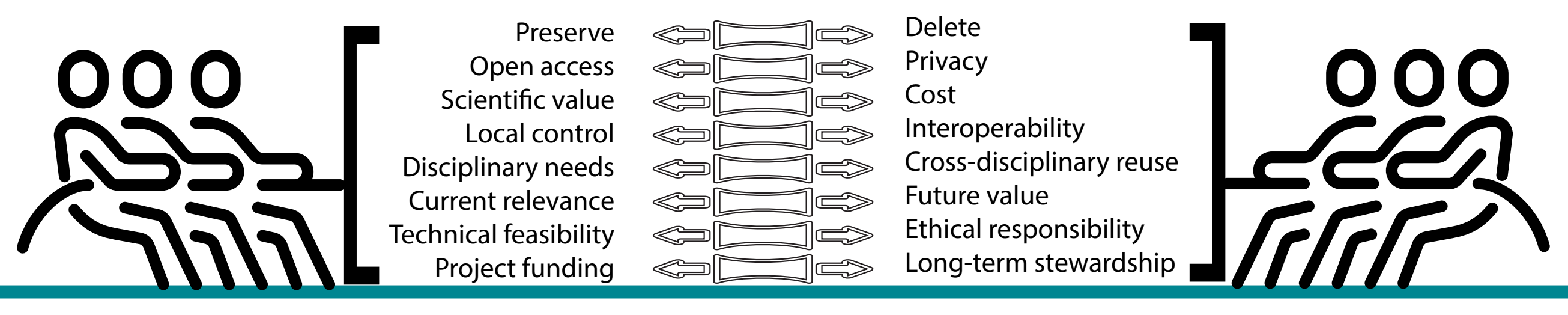
Possible response
Treat ethical responsibility as a lifecycle responsibility involving researchers, repositories, communities and participants.

09 | TRUST

Problem
Long-term reuse depends on confidence in provenance, integrity, governance and stewardship.

Possible response
Strengthen provenance, audit trails, governance, regular reappraisal and trustworthy-repository practices.


There are... tensions...

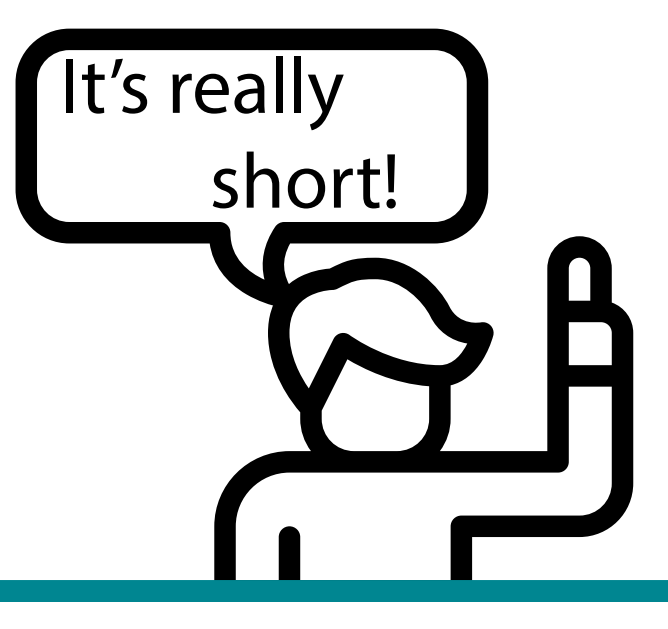

Preserve	Delete
Open access	Privacy
Scientific value	Cost
Local control	Interoperability
Disciplinary needs	Cross-disciplinary reuse
Current relevance	Future value
Technical feasibility	Ethical responsibility
Project funding	Long-term stewardship

Your experience matters...

We're finalising this output and we need your help

1. Which of these challenges do you encounter?
2. Which important challenge is missing?
3. Which proposed responses would actually work in your environment?
4. What would make them difficult to implement?
5. What should happen when a retention period expires?
6. Who should be responsible — and who should pay?

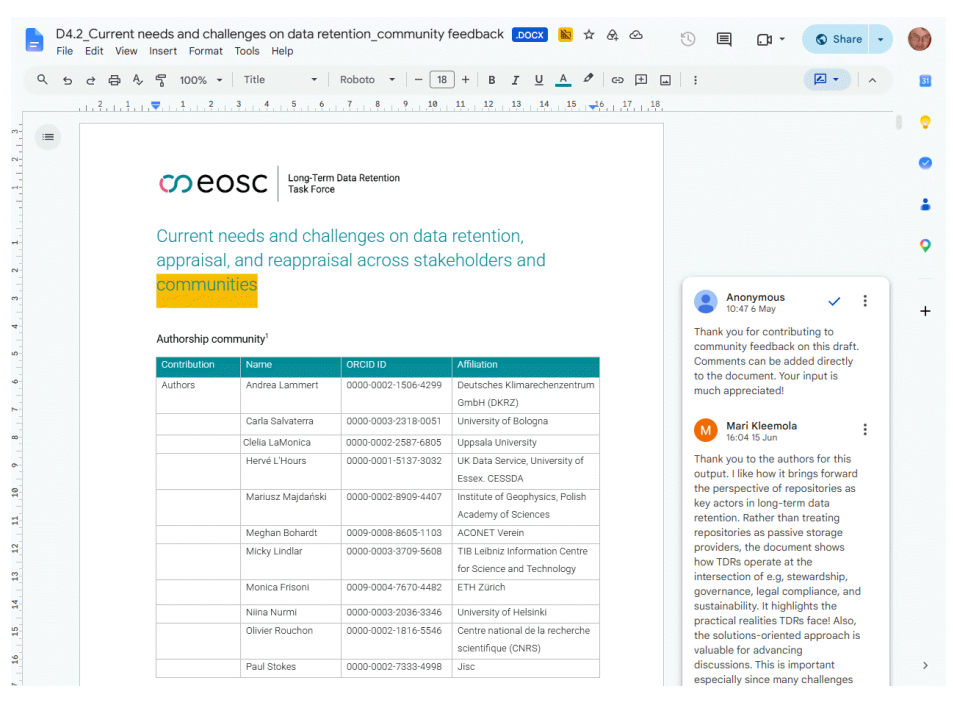
https://forms.gle/LWe1WGttYEPDyMjN6


It's really short!

SCAN → COMMENT → HELP SHAPE THE FINAL GUIDANCE

Comment directly in the document

https://tinyurl.com/yeundxwe


D4.2_Current needs and challenges on data retention_community feedback .DOCX

eosc Long-Term Data Retention Task Force

Current needs and challenges on data retention, appraisal, and reappraisal across stakeholders and communities

Authorship community[1]

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Anonymous
10:47 6 May
Thank you for contributing to community feedback on this draft. Comments can be added directly to the document. Your input is much appreciated!

Mari Kleemola
16:04 15 Jun
Thank you to the authors for this output. I like how it brings forward the perspective of repositories as key actors in long-term data retention. Rather than treating repositories as passive storage providers, the document shows how TDRs operate at the intersection of e.g, stewardship, governance, legal compliance, and sustainability. It highlights the practical realities TDRs face! Also, the solutions-oriented approach is valuable for advancing discussions. This is important especially since many challenges

Acknowledgements

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